

Report on the outcomes of a presentation and participation - Young Researcher and Innovator Conference¹

Action number: **CA21129**

Grantee name: **Olga Zagovora**

Conference Details

Conference title: The 76th Annual International Communication Association (ICA)

Conference web-page: <https://www.icahdq.org/mpage/ICA26>

Conference venue²: Cape Town, South Africa

Accepted contribution details

Title of the presentation: *Stereotype Dynamics in Multilingual LLMs: Unpacking Gender and Migration Biases*

Type of the presentation: oral

Co-authors: Ljubiša Bojić, Ana Jovančević, Olga Zagovora, and Velibor Ilić

Session name: HMC preconference “Human-Machine Communication and Inequalities: Contexts, Challenges, and Opportunities.”

Outcome of the conference participation

The paper examined how prompting can be used to study stereotypes and biases in large language models (LLMs), with a particular focus on gender and immigration across different cultural contexts. The presentation contributed to ongoing discussions on algorithmic bias, fairness, and the societal implications of generative AI systems. The session provided valuable feedback on the study's methodological approach, operationalization of bias, and the challenges of conducting cross-cultural comparisons using LLMs. The discussions will be incorporated into the further development of this research agenda and future publications.

In addition to presenting my research, I attended a range of sessions organized by the Human-Machine Communication (HMC) Division and the Computational Methods Division. These sessions covered recent developments in artificial intelligence, large language models, computational social science methods, digital inequalities, and human-machine interaction. Participation in these panels and paper sessions provided valuable insights into current theoretical and methodological debates in the field, informed my ongoing research on LLMs and computational methods, and facilitated exchanges with researchers working on related topics. The knowledge gained through these sessions will contribute to future research activities and collaborative initiatives within the COST Action network.

¹ This report is submitted by the grantee to the Action MC for approval and for claiming payment of the awarded grant. The Grant Awarding Coordinator coordinates the evaluation of this report on behalf of the Action MC and instructs the Grant Holder Manager to verify the grant documents compliance and proceed with the payment.

² For an online conference, specify virtual participation; for hybrid conferences, specify whether it is an in-person or virtual participation.

Participation in the ICA conference provided excellent opportunities for networking and knowledge exchange with leading scholars working on artificial intelligence, computational social science, digital communication, and human-machine communication. These exchanges provided insights into current developments in AI and communication research and opened possibilities for future international collaborations.

The conference also provided an important opportunity to advance collaboration within our COST Action network. Meetings and discussions with COST Action members focused on planning future joint activities and research initiatives. These conversations helped strengthen existing connections within the network and contributed to the development of future collaborative outputs.

Overall, participation in ICA 2026 contributed substantially to the dissemination of research findings, the expansion of international research networks, and the development of future collaborations both within and beyond the COST Action. The travel grant enabled active engagement with the international research community and supported the advancement of ongoing and future research activities related to artificial intelligence, communication, and computational social science.

Acknowledgement of inclusion of necessary supporting documents to claim the grant

I confirm that the following documents have been uploaded on e-COST as an integral part of this report:

- the certificate of conference attendance issued by the conference organiser.
- the programme of the conference or book of abstracts / proceedings indicating the presentation (oral or poster) of the grantee.